



Teoma: ① Click here to fine tune the limited configuration options; choose which buttons you want displayed and set the other options. While you can't configure the Search options, it does yield some pretty useful resource sites. ② Highlighting is enabled from here. ③ To e-mail a copy of the page, click here

do it efficiently. News services, encyclopaedias and other authoritative reference works are available aplenty on the Net and you can also have them on your browser for immediate access.

Merriam-Webster Toolbar

Web site: www.m-w.com

Whether you are a writer or a reader, this toolbar is made for you. Just type in your subject and hit search, or highlight a term on a Web page and right-click to locate its meaning across the venerable Merriam-Webster OnLine. A pop-up window answers your question and gives you a link to an audio pronunciation of the word. This window also gives you relevant links and some historical information. You can use the dictionary as well as the associated Webster



Merriam-Webster: ① Click here to configure the toolbar. ② Enter the search term within the text window and to obtain a dictionary definition, ③ click on the Dictionary button. ④ Use the Thesaurus button for more information on the word. Both open up in a separate popup window, so your current page view remains intact. ⑤ The Word of the Day button opens a popup that gives you a word accompanied by some history

Thesaurus. While you could access quite a lot from the Webster portal online, you do not have access to the unabridged Webster online dictionary—this is a premium service. Incidentally, many search toolbars link up their dictionary and definition sections to Merriam-Webster.

MSNBC's News Alert

Web site: www.msnbc.com/tools/newstools/d/news_alert.asp

If you want to be up to date with the latest news, get hold of MSNBC's free news alert. This program adds an icon to your system tray and gives news alerts by flashing the icon. Clicking the icon opens up a popup window that gives you the headline and link to the complete story. Play with the settings to get it working to your liking and to set up personalised alerts for stories of your interest.

BBC News Ticker

Web site: <http://news.bbc.co.uk/hi/english/static/services/ticker/default.stm>

This one runs as a ticker on the top of your screen. You can configure the ticker to deliver the kind of news you would like to see. It continuously provides updated news headlines with a link to the complete stories at the BBC Web site.



BBC: Tune in for news, anytime

Bargains on the Web

Using some pretty sophisticated techniques, these little browser add-ons will rummage the Internet and get you just what you ordered for. But beware. When it comes to bargains that look too good to be true, they probably are. Use these tools and some common sense to bag some great bargains.

The Side Step Travel Search Engine

Web site: www.sidestep.com

Use this travel search engine to locate the lowest airline fares, hotel bookings and the lowest car rental costs all around the world. This metasearch travel engine combs all the low-cost travel sites to locate the best deals for you. It saves much of your planning time by searching and then comparing some 90 odd supplier sites such as Travelocity.com (www.travelocity.com), Expedia (www.expedia.com), Cheap Tickets (www.cheaptickets.com) and Lowestfare.com (www.lowestfare.com). It occupies a sidebar that sits on the left side of your page, so you can use it while you work. However, it is not the fastest search engine and restricts its search to starred hotels within India. This renders it useless to low-budget travellers.

The interface lets you choose between airlines, hotels and cars. You can flip through tabs and search for low airfares, cheaper hotel rates and car rentals.

Online, but not within your Browser

These are sites that have search services to locate information. Some of these sites offer specialised services, such as powerful metasearch tools. A 'metasearch' is similar to an ordinary search, with one major difference—metasearches query and scan across many search engines at the same time to locate information. These search engines are programmed to avoid duplicate listings. In some of them, you can use simple, natural language in the same way you communicate while speaking.

Generalised metasearch

If you are looking for vast metasearch engines that harness the power of several search technologies, check out MetaCrawler (www.metacrawler.com) and Mamma (www.mamma.com). Both organise the results into clusters by word, category or level of popularity, without duplicating list-

ings. Dogpile

(www.dogpile.com)

presents the results

sequentially. Also

notable is Invisible Web

(www.invisibleweb.com), a search engine that can ferret out information located within specific databases—other search engines find information on Web pages but fall short while searching for information embedded within databases.

Science-related research

If you are looking for reliable papers in any branch of study, you'll find them all using the Scirus search engine (www.scirus.com). Scirus scans across university Web sites and online paper repositories for your academic needs. Also check out Find Articles (www.findarticles.com), to locate magazine and journal articles.

